

SNZ #CLASSIFIEDS

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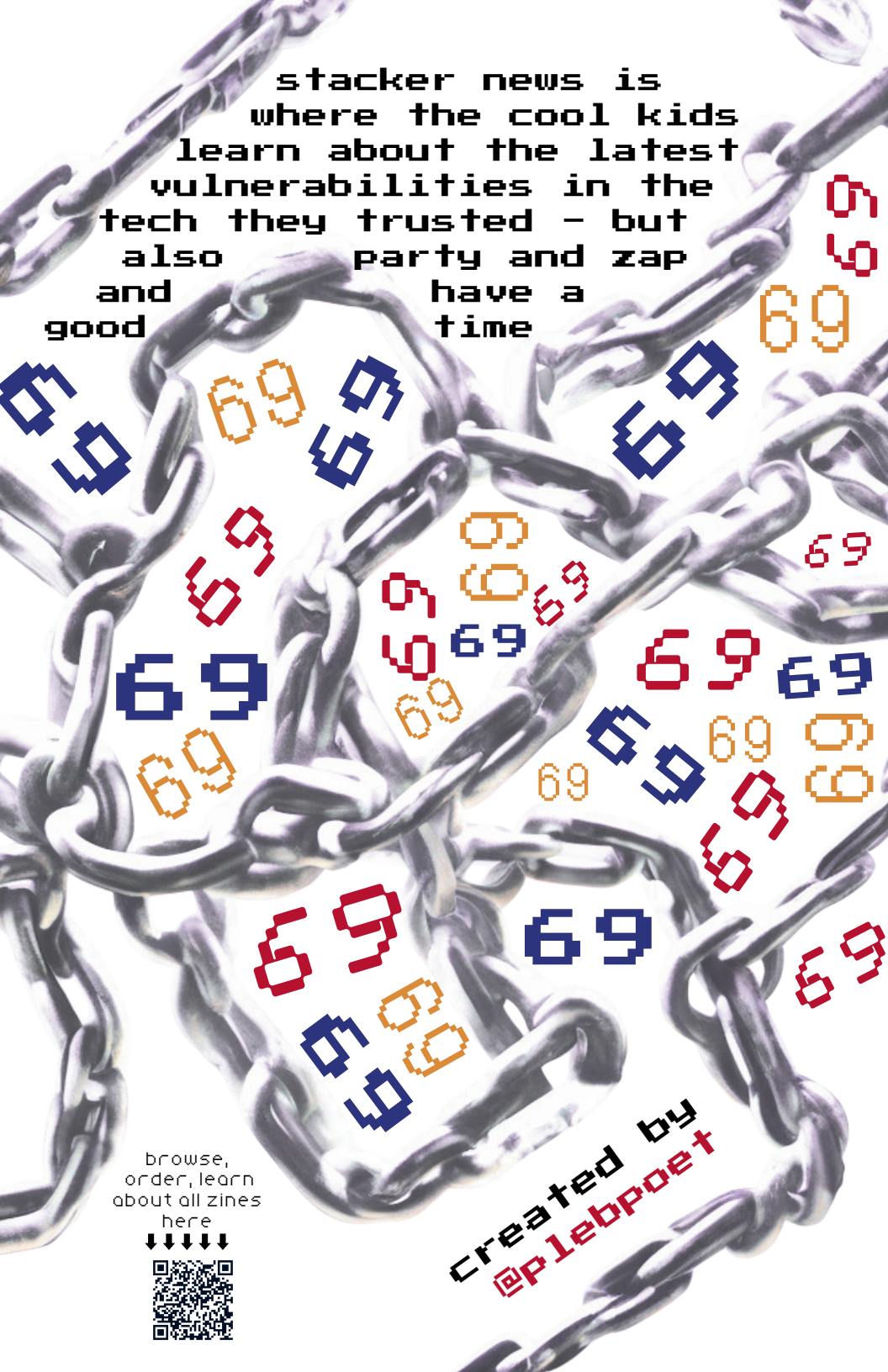
TALK STOCKS
STACK SATS

The last spot in the
Stacker Sports
fantasy football
league is **STILL OPEN**

*(and it comes with
the top draft pick!).*



Issue #69 Aug 22-Aug 28 964 528



stacker news is
where the cool kids
learn about the latest
vulnerabilities in the
tech they trusted - but
also party and zap
and have a
good time

browse,
order, learn
about all zines
here



created by
@plebpoet

Escape the Matrix with Natural Springs



3573 sats \ 4 comments \ @AliceA
22 Aug Travel food_and_drinks AGORA



Part I: Zapped a Wine-Maker ⚡🍷🍷

Recently I visited Turkovich Tasting Room on route to a nature retreat. This is a Californian family-owned winery that accepts Bitcoin and sometimes hosts events for Bitcoiners. 🍷🍷🍷

The tasting-room shop offers artisan cheeses, honey, charcuterie, local olive oil, etc.



I have been to the winery & the tasting room a few times before. One time, the staff had no idea what to do and had no one to ask for help, so I left without buying anything. 🤔

This time was different:

- I entered the shop, walked straight to the cashier, and asked: "can I buy some things with Bitcoin?" The cashier fiddled around with the payment terminal, unsure where to click, and replied: "shop around and I'll figure it out."
- I then saw a bartender come up, she clicked thru the terminal herself, while demonstrating the steps to the first cashier. The transaction went thru instantly. I got a slice of artisan cheese and local honey to enjoy during my nature retreat! 🍷🍷

This merchant uses a 3rd party LN wallet (Speed Wallet) for payments. *The shop offers a 10% discount when paying in Bitcoin.* All-in-all, a success story.

So the lesson here is - be consistent, keep using Bitcoin and asking to pay in Bitcoin, whether it's "bear" or "bull" market. The builders of the parallel economy cannot build without our sats, so if you do not use Bitcoin, there will be nowhere for you to live on Bitcoin, and really, nowhere for you to eat or drink well, since a fiat-standard food becomes more toxic & unfit for human consumption over time.

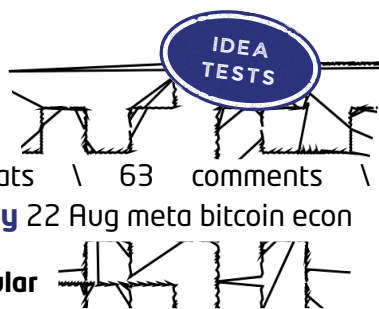
P.S. The bartender also noticed my Earth Runners shoes and related some of her foot issues, for which she is trying wider shoes & massage roller.

< Part II continues online >

NOBODY likes the idea of pay to post (outside SN)

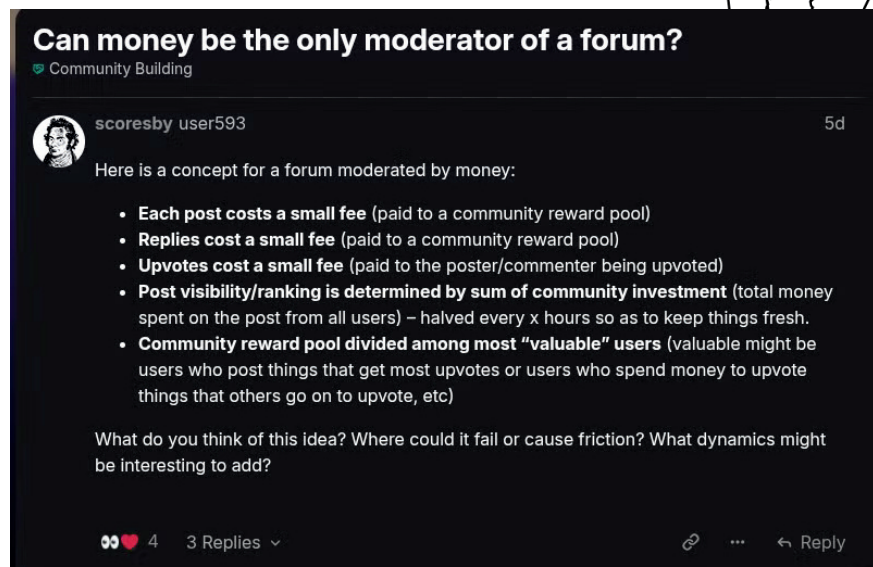


10.6k sats \ 63 comments \ @Scoresby 22 Aug meta bitcoin econ



Pay to post / money is the moderator is NOT popular

I spent some time last week posting on other forums about the mechanics of SN. I made a generic post describing how money might be used as a moderator (basically describing how we do things here), like this:



And then tried to have a conversation about the idea with the people on a bunch of different forums. This was a very enlightening exercise.

Money as a moderator is not popular with the lefties

I found a forum called [32-Bit Cafe](#) that seems to enjoy meta conversations about moderation and online forums. They were not too enthusiastic to the idea of money being the moderator:

- “The userbase selects for those privileged enough to have discretionary funds and whom don’t see socializing in such a place as problematic? I believe such an environment would reproduce the hierarchies already present in society. Those with more cash to spend on hand get more visibility on this platform, so the opinions of the powerful get amplified. Which also means selecting for people who believe such hierarchies are justified. Influencers and advertisers are more likely to avoid the platform because it has few users and no governance to take down bigoted or otherwise harmful posts. The fact posts and upvotes cost money would not be a factor as paying money to promote posts on social media is already the norm.”

However, the thread eventually got to a more thoughtful level.

- “Wow, this is fascinating but (in my personal opinion) horrible. I assume part of why it works with relatively little friction in this instance is because the de facto subject of much of the forum is the currency itself. I guess if there were a load of people who Really Loved The Euro or whatever, they might pay a few euro cents to post on a forum that was mostly about the euro, because they just love the euro so much that they get a little dopamine blast every time they get to spend a few cents of it. But I’m not sure if those people exist for the euro, or indeed any currency other than the one that the actual forum deals in, and I’m not sure that a forum about the euro would be that interesting either.”

A surprising trend that showed up here and continued across other forums was that people thought the system would work better with *pretend* money or just points. I understood this to mean that I hadn’t done a very good job expressing my concept.

The normies also do not like the idea

I also posted the idea in the Odd Lots (a popular Bloomberg econ podcast) discord, with similarly negative responses...

The conversation got derailed into hating on SomethingAwful shortly after this.

(Curiously enough, SomethingAwful is now a pay-gated forum: you have to pay \$10 to join.)

The Community Building StackExchange downvoted my question as not helpful or well researched and no one responded.

BitcoinTalk does not like the idea (nor, seemingly, Stacker News)

I posted the idea on this BitcoinTalk thread and it received near universal rejection. It seems most users thought I was proposing a change to BitcoinTalk itself and were somewhat irate about the idea (even accusing me of having been put up to it by Theymos). When I tried to explain that I was not trying to talk propose any changes to BitcoinTalk but rather describing a different forum concept, I was accused of SEO spamming (I regrettably included a link to SN in one of my replies).

Takeaways

I have a few more places I’m going to try to pitch money as the moderator, but the most obvious learning from this adventure is that unless you are in to Austrian Economics and Libertarianism, you probably have a very negative reaction to the idea of money as a moderator and paying to post. Even the Austrians and Libertarians are doubtful of the concept -- language about markets I think will do better with them (Stacker News as an attention auction?, Stacker News as an information market?) than language about moderation.

Most people expressed some amount of being turned-off or off-put by the idea of paying to post. Most people thought money as a moderator = richrank. A tangential learning, but relevant, is that so many people have a negative opinion of bitcoin. Probably this is thanks to all the crypto scammers, but I found that most people immediately shut down when I brought up bitcoin. I’m open to suggestions as to where I should bring the money is a moderator idea next.

How Our Meetup Buys Pizza



6504 sats \ 23 comments \
@phaedrus 23 Aug bitcoin

Previously I argued that until you spend it, bitcoin isn't money.

This is the follow-up: a plain field report on how our Santa Cruz meetup actually buys its pizza in bitcoin and few lessons I learned along the way in case you wanna do something similar.

<https://bitcoinpolis.substack.com/p/how-our-meetup-buys-pizza>



Would love to hear from people trying to do similar things or any feedback.

comments

601 sats \ 1 reply \ @Scoresby 24 Aug

You have a couple of insights I'm here are absolute gold.

"I convinced my friend who owns a pizza shop to accept bitcoin and we set up a community wallet so anyone can chime in, and buying pizza turned into a collaboration the whole meetup does together."

The community wallet is a really fun idea, and making it something that the whole community works on as a way to spend Bitcoin is excellent. I'm going to try to implement this.

"chipping in is one motion: scan the QR, send a few sats, watch it land on a page everyone can see. Once a month we spend that pot on pizza from a local shop. Contributions in bitcoin, a transparent community treasury, spending out to a real local business."

This is so cool. It's easy to lose track of wins like this when the mindset is "find someone to sponsor it" or "just pay for it myself."
I suspect the energizing value of doing it the way you describe will bear a lot of fruit in the future.

"Lower the ask until it's a yes."

I know that I have made the boil the oceans mistake by trying to go whole hog when perhaps a much smaller ask was the better way to go.
Something to think about here.
Well played, sir!



16.2k sats \ 77 comments \
@bief57 24 Aug Politics_And_Law



It's exhausting being without electricity

This is a topic I talk about quite often; it's incredibly exhausting. We're experiencing more frequent power outages, and they last for longer periods. A year ago, the power was going out two to three times a week for three hours at a time. For the past two months, it's been going out daily for six consecutive hours. Six hours during which many of us can't work. The signal is weak, apps don't function properly, and in my husband's and my case, our laptop shuts down (the battery is damaged) and only works when plugged in. Yes, we have a UPS to keep the Wi-Fi active, but as I mentioned, the signal gets slower and only lasts four to five hours at most. Mobile data stops working a whole host of obstacles that prevent us from working effectively. There's no set schedule for the power outages; we can spend the entire night without electricity, uncomfortable in the heat, with mosquitoes biting and bothering us. It's impossible to sleep well like that. I refuse to normalize this situation like many others, and I don't celebrate when the power goes out for shorter periods either. It infuriates me to hear people saying things like, "It's great that they only cut the power for 4 hours today," or "It's wonderful that they didn't cut the power today."

I'm writing this with my cell phone battery at 57%, with several bites and mosquitoes buzzing in my ear. I'll be without electricity until midnight.

Sometimes I want to be patient, I want to see the positive side, but not today. I have to stay calm because, in the end, there's nothing I can do to fix this today, and at my age, it's very easy for me to have facial paralysis, a heart attack, or a stroke if I don't control or release the stress.



sometimes we do games

381 sats \ 5 comments \ @sn 24 Aug memes

30 sats \ 0 replies \

@mkmloom 25 Aug



Yo! help
your monkey
get out of
there!

Quick! Tell him which wallets
are ordained and blessed,
he needs to know!



Has anyone ever felt disconnected from where you were born and grew up?



Home
Sick

5224 sats \ 58 comments \
[@Natalia](#) 25 Aug AskSN

You often see people like fish out of water when they are out of their comfort zone or, let's say, their homelands, but what happens when you slowly adapt to another environment and then somehow evolve into something else, let's say you got a complete new set of focus, interests, or attitude toward life.

Then one day you look back and feel so disconnected from the other fish that you once knew, so should you keep becoming yourself or try to become familiar with the old fish again?

comments

108 sats \ 30 replies \
[@Undisciplined](#) 25 Aug

I haven't been back to my homeland in over a decade. I expect to feel right at home when I go back, but we'll see. I don't think I've fully acclimated to where I moved to.

257 sats \ 3 replies \ [@Murch](#) 25 Aug
I spent 11th grade abroad. I was expecting things to be different on going abroad and the culture shock was quite manageable. I didn't expect the reverse culture shock when I returned after missing a year of high school, especially the year that people turned 17. '

Now that I've been living abroad for over nine years, some things also surprise me when I visit. You don't really explicitly know the things you got used to abroad that just aren't so back home.

10 sats \ 2 replies \ [@Natalia](#)
OP 25 Aug

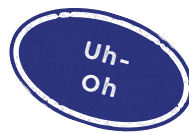
Actually, I'm quite surprised to see how many usual stackers have similar life experiences (moving to other foreign lands) I'm not sure if that somehow leads us to BTC?

212 sats \ 4 replies \ [@optimism](#) 25 Aug
I haven't lived in my "homeland" in 30+ years. I even feel more at home in some places where I lived for shorter times. I still go, I still have fun when I do, I still meet people from long ago and have a good time. In the end we're all human beings, culture is a thing, tribe is a thing, but it doesn't have to define everything. I think that keeping an open mind helps in these matters.

Oh, and I never talk politics with anyone. Which helps a lot.

< discussion
continues online >

Take your CLN node offline.



5348 sats \ 69 comments \ @anon
26 Aug bitcoin lightning

"Like many open source Bitcoin projects, CLN has received a number of AI-generated CVE reports from multiple sources over the past 10 days. Our small team, together with several invaluable open source contributors, has been working intensively to validate and triage these reports and develop fixes where needed.

We're now working through a broader remediation strategy. The first step is a point release containing many of these fixes, and we will strongly recommend upgrading. We're aiming to have an initial version of the point release available within the next few days.

As the situation has evolved, so has our remediation strategy. Rather than publishing the point release this week we will make binaries available for a release containing fixes for many of the reported vulnerabilities. The details of the release will remain under embargo for two weeks. The binaries will be accompanied by the team's signatures confirming reproducibility.

During the embargo period, we strongly encourage everyone to upgrade. At the end of the two weeks, the full release and associated details will be made public.

*If you choose not to upgrade, **we recommend taking your node --offline.** Given the known risks, we will not support previous releases, including 26.04. The 26.09 release remains planned for late September."*

< the quoted text
comes from a
screenshot from
Discord >

inb4 "Discord is a walled garden and you shouldn't use it." Stay uninformed then.

If you found this useful, In lieu of cuck credits, send actual money to this address:
bc1qqjkcdqaqs8447w6wr78qqfmsxh9skqf08tk5gj

comments

620 sats \ 2 replies \ @TonyAgora 26 Aug

This is extremely disappointing from Blockstream.

Core lightning has been some of my favorite bitcoin software for many years, i have championed it in both Dev and adoption realms.

And now... to see a small group of insiders be alerted of critical issues, with zero proper public disclosure or announcement? This is not how you do security fixes or look after users.

What if this semi-quiet embargo announcement had piqued the interest of evil individuals (it certainly has now, AIs are being pointed at the repo right fucking now)?

What if I had lost funds or private information regarding customer data?

Why the fuck is someone called MADELINEVIBES, who did an "introduction to github" LAST YEAR, managing security releases for mission critical software?

1603 sats \ 1 reply \ @Murch 26 Aug

I confirmed that this message was sent by a mod in the CLN discord. Trying to get another confirmation from one of the main CLN developers.



16k sats \ 17 comments \
@leo 28 Aug DIY
zaps forwarded to
@thecurtic (50%)

My Friend and I Revived an Old Coca Cola Vending Machine

On Craigslist and Facebook Marketplace you can often find beautifully preserved old vending machines. Especially those from the 60s and 70s tend to be built quite robustly. The coin receptor is often broken, missing, or only accepts quarters, so you will rarely see them in action. Most commonly they sit in man-caves, clubs and garages as private fridges.

The irony is not lost on me that the one piece that is broken in these machines is exactly the one we're looking to replace.

We bought this Coca Cola machine, built in the late 60s or early 70s in Kansas City by Vendo, for CA\$500 online. They are relatively light (~100kg) and have a somewhat fatal flaw: You can "steal" the beverage by opening it while the bottle is still locked inside and holding a cup underneath it.



That's two reasons these machine were often not deployed outside, and tend to be in good shape. We are only the third owners, Coca Cola sold it to one of their maintenance workers, who sold it to us. The machine runs with Freon, and has never been refilled. The drinks are ice cold. We had to do zero work on the machine beyond transporting it and getting it ready for the Lightning age. 🍻

Retrofitting the machine for Lightning payments was really easy. We removed the broken coin receptor and replaced it with a Raspberry Pi Zero and a relay. The Pi listens to messages from our LNbits instance over websockets, and every time a payment is coming through the LNURLp printed on the front of the device the relay is triggered and exactly one bottle can be removed by hand from the machine. *The code is open source and available here*, and it also includes support for an e-ink display that we plan to add, just to give a visual confirmation of when a payment is coming in.



You can visit the machine and buy various premium soda at the newly opened DCTRL hackerspace in downtown Vancouver, BC at 330 West Hastings Street.

The name of the machine: **Nakamoto's Numinous Nerve Nectar**

k00b's dilemma



11.1k sats \ 47 comments \ [@4ac452af1f](#) 29 Aug meta
zaps forwarded to [@k00b](#) (100%)

Option 1: do you have a website with 3 users and keep the existing payment methods?

Option 2: do you add easy to use custodial payment methods, with a BIG disclaimer, and potentially get more users?

It's not hard to understand why option 2 is more appealing if you're trying to build a community. It's not k00b's fault that all the existing non-custodial options are hard to set up and hard to manage. They are a huge barrier for newcomers. Also, should someone who doesn't know what they are doing operate a lightning node? Would you prefer that?

You could say: "but I did the work upfront, invested time, so they should also do it." Yes, but you also did not get to experience SN that whole time. It does not have to be that way. By inviting more users to the platform, they get to experience it and learn here, not somewhere else. You will have a chance to tell people about all the things you care about, here, but if they leave or never join, they might be gone forever.

It is as if all the purists know deep down that all the current options are terrible, so they worry that they will be outnumbered. You need to accept the reality: most people want the easiest thing possible. That's it. If you care about non-custodial, go make it easier than everything else.

comments

479 sats \ 5 replies \ [@chungkingexpress](#) 29 Aug

My impression in the past from some "Bitcoin purists" is that they parrot and repeat talking points they heard on a podcast but don't understand what it takes to run a business or the reality of social interactions. Ultimately they are after an exclusive social club with highly-disagreeable people like themselves .

How about just giving a few options ranging from custodial to non-custodial and let people decide and learn? Purists can fuck off back to their Rabbit Hole Recap Coldcard and conspiracy theories?

745 sats \ 4 replies \ [@optimism](#) 29 Aug

> "outnumbered"

"Purists" (even though there isn't really such a thing) have been outnumbered since forever. "Purists" just win battles sometimes because the garden variety Hearn repeater is often careless in the tradeoffs they assume the whole must be okay with to mandatorily adapt, and at critical times the conservative angle is one of safety. It's a spectrum anyway, not really absolute. I may be more conservative than you, but more progressive than someone else when we discuss the merit of Spark. And on some other topic the roles may be flipped.

> "You need to [..]"

Please, don't tell me what to do, anon. If you think that I am delusional, let's discuss the alleged delusion, not the merit of my being outside the walls of your box. You don't know whether I am outside of it because I perceive reality differently, or because I am pursuing a current non-reality to transform things into, that is radically different from what you perceive as truth. Maybe I am not having all these privileges you're assuming everyone has, and my reality would be different for you too were you in my situation, location, social position. Or maybe I am simply insane, who knows (most likely, haha.) Either way, if "Purists" need to do anything this will eliminate the purism. That's not really how I've participated in the bitcoin ecosystem these past years. We always have had diverse angles, a very wide range of goals and we all just agree on some very abstract consensus rules that make the blocks into a nice chain.

There's no need for demarcations. There is no us vs them. Not everything needs to be polarized. Let's just try to discuss things, preferably without too much savagery.

Bottom line, SN could definitely use growth. Reducing friction is a great way to at least disable the inverse of that, but it is really, really hard because the problem space of connected wallets is small. Only a few people are working on solving it.

110 sats \ 11 replies \ [@SimpleStacker](#) 29 Aug

Excuse me but there are, like, 15 of us here